ABEL YAGUBYAN

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EDUCATION

University of Georgia, Athens: Ph.D. Artificial Intelligence **August 2026 - Present**

Northwestern University: M.S. Computer Science, Summa Cum Laude **September 2022 - June 2023**
University of California, Berkeley: B.A. Computer Science, B.A. Applied Mathematics **August 2018 - May 2022**

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

UGA LLM Lab, University of Georgia
PhD Researcher, advised by Prof. Tianming Liu *August 2026 – Present*

- Study how AI agents and evaluators are graded and rewarded, and where rewards pay for work that never happened.
- Found claim-graded rewards in **10 of 63** public RL hub environments; built a read-back test and *MedAgentBench-Verified*.

PUBLICATIONS

- **Yagubyan, A.**, et al. *Who Checks the Checker? Phantom Actions in Agent RL Environments.* arXiv, Nov. 2026.
- **Yagubyan, A.**, et al. *Who Can Touch the Score? Evaluator Isolation in Self-Improving AI Systems.* arXiv, Nov. 2026.
- Jiang, H., **Yagubyan, A.**, et al. *Anatomical Prediction Error for Medical Image Reading*. CVPR 2027 submission.
- **Yagubyan, A.**, et al. *Action-Conditioned JEPA for Electronic Health Records.* In progress.
- **Yagubyan, A.** *The Coin Flip Judge? Reliability and Bias in LLM-as-a-Judge Evaluation.* GroundLM @ EMNLP 2026.
- **Yagubyan, A.** *How Consistent Are LLM Agents? Measuring Behavioral Reproducibility in Multi-Step Tool-Calling Pipelines.* arXiv, Apr. 2026.
- Zheng, W.; Stahl, B. E.; Filippenko, A. V.; et al., incl. **Yagubyan, A.** *The Lick Observatory Supernova Search follow-up program: photometry data release of 70 SESNe.* MNRAS 512(3), 2022.
- **Yagubyan, A.**; Garcia, D. *Seamless Embedding of Programming IDEs into Computer-Based Testing Software.* ACM SIGCSE 2022.

OPEN SOURCE

TruLens (Snowflake), Area Triager **September 2026 – Present**

- Listed maintainer; **30 merged PRs** across 3 releases, including `Jury.repeated` (repeated-trial LLM judging).

inspect_evals (UK AI Security Institute), Contributor **September 2026 – Present**

- **4 merged PRs** on metric aggregation and scoring, credited in 3 releases.

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

Aivaro
Co-founder & CEO, Y Combinator Spring 2026 *March 2026 – June 2026*

- Architected a deterministic LLM-to-workflow system that turns natural language into executable DAGs with retries, monitoring, and approval gating, automating SMB operations across Gmail, Stripe, Google Sheets, and Calendly.
- Deployed for booking, payment, and reconciliation, **saving 5 hours/week** and **cutting no-shows from 20–25% to 8%**.

C3.ai
Senior Data Scientist (promoted in under 18 months) *May 2024 – March 2026*

- Led predictive maintenance and generative AI deployments for Shell, ExxonMobil, Dow, and Bloom Energy, **delivering over $10M in value** and **deploying 1,000+ models** per project.
- Developed a foundational healthcare transformer **trained on 1M+ U.S. patient records and 1B+ datapoints**.
- Created *SpeedyREL*, an internal tool for deploying reconstruction-based predictive maintenance models; **adopted by 5+ projects**, **cut deployment time by up to 50%**, and became part of onboarding for all Reliability teams.

FibonAI
Co-founder, UC Berkeley SkyDeck Pad-13 *June 2023 – February 2024*

- Built an LLM-powered workspace for in-house legal teams (intake, contracts, matter management, AI assistants); **onboarded 8 General Counsels/CLOs** with a **60% demo conversion rate** and **100% weekly user growth**.

Apple x UC Berkeley
Software Engineering Intern *May 2021 – August 2021*

- Project lead building CS61C architecture and ML projects for **4,000+ students** in C, C++, SIMD, OpenMP, and RISC-V.

SKILLS & SERVICE

- **Languages:** Python, C++, C, CUDA, Rust, Go, Java, JavaScript, SQL, MATLAB, R
- **Tools:** PyTorch, TensorFlow, Hugging Face, XGBoost, Inspect AI, TruLens, MPI, UPC++, Docker, Kubernetes, AWS, GCP
- **Peer review:** 200+ reviews across 9 Elsevier journals, including *Engineering Applications of AI* and *Neural Networks*